

Indians line up for water in a slum area of Hyderabad in 2007. India suffered a severe water crisis in 2018, and demand is projected to be twice the available supply by 2030.

“Life requires access to clean water; to deny the right to water is to deny the right to life. The fight for the right to water is an idea whose time has come.”

Maude Barlow

Wasted water

A larger human population uses more water, and a large proportion of that is wasted, especially in developed countries. Sources of freshwater have dried up (for example, much of the Rio Grande between Mexico and the US) or are becoming too polluted to use. The Ganges in India and the Citarum in